

StockKeep

Shop Inventory & Stock Tracking System

User Manual

User_Manual.pdf — Standalone End-User Guide

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Screenshots could not be captured for this edition because no browser automation tool was available in the environment used to prepare this documentation. Every screen is marked with a clearly labelled placeholder, e.g. [INSERT SCREENSHOT --- Dashboard], at the exact point a real screenshot should be inserted. No screenshot has been fabricated. The student should replace each placeholder with a real capture from a running instance before submission.

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1. Introduction

StockKeep is a web-based inventory and stock tracking tool for a single small shop. This manual explains how to access the system, log in, and use every feature available to shop staff: dashboard, inventory management, stock movements, sales recording, supplier management, reports, settings, and the AI assistant. It is written for a non-technical shop staff audience.

2. System Requirements

- A modern desktop or mobile web browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox, or Safari, recent version).
- An internet connection to reach the deployed StockKeep URL, and (optionally) for AI chat / AI insight features to reach Google's Gemini service.
- No software installation is required — StockKeep runs entirely in the browser.

3. Accessing the Application

Open the StockKeep web address provided by your administrator (see `Deployment_and_Source_Links.txt` for this project's live URL, once deployed). You will land on the **Login** screen.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Login Screen]

4. Login

1. Enter the shop passcode into the passcode field.
2. Press **Unlock** (or press Enter).
3. If the passcode is correct, you are taken to the Dashboard. If incorrect, an error message is shown and you may try again.

Note: the current build uses a single shared passcode for the whole shop (default **1234** unless your administrator has configured a different value via the **APP_PASSCODE** environment variable) — there are no individual staff logins. See **Technical_Debt_Plan.pdf** (TD-01) regarding the separate, currently non-functional passcode field under Settings.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Login Error State]

5. Dashboard

After logging in you land on the **Dashboard** tab, showing:

- Key figures (KPIs): total revenue, current inventory value, total item count, units sold.
- A revenue trend chart for the last 14 days.
- A breakdown of inventory by category.
- Recent activity (latest stock movements and sales).
- An AI-generated summary/insight of the shop's current state (or a rule-based summary if the AI service is unavailable — you will not see an error either way).

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Dashboard]

6. Inventory Management

6.1 Viewing Inventory

Select the **Inventory** tab to see the full item list: name, SKU, category, quantity, price, and status (in stock / low stock / out of stock). Use the search box to filter by name or SKU, and the category dropdown to filter by category.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Inventory List]

6.2 Adding Items

1. From the Inventory tab, select **Add Item**.
2. Fill in the item name (required), category, starting quantity, low-stock threshold, price, and optionally a location, description, expiry date, and supplier.
3. Select **Save**. The system automatically generates a unique SKU (e.g., SKU-013) — you do not need to enter one.
4. If any field is invalid (e.g., a negative quantity), you will see a validation message and the item will not be saved.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Add Item Form]

6.3 Viewing Item Detail

Select any item in the Inventory list to open its **Item Detail** view, showing its full information, supplier, complete stock-movement history, and sales history for that item.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Item Detail]

6.4 Editing and Deleting Items

From the Item Detail view you can edit any field or delete the item entirely. Deleting an item also removes its associated stock-movement and sale history (cascade delete).

7. Stock-In

To record newly received stock:

1. Open the item's Detail view.
2. Select **Stock In**.
3. Enter the quantity received and select **Confirm**.
4. The item's quantity increases immediately and a Stock-In entry is added to its movement history.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Stock In Dialog]

8. Stock-Out

To record stock leaving for a reason other than a sale (e.g., damage, internal use):

1. Open the item's Detail view.
2. Select **Stock Out**.
3. Enter the quantity and select **Confirm**.
4. The system will **not** allow a Stock-Out that would take the item's quantity below zero — you will see an error message if you try.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Stock Out Dialog]

9. Recording a Sale

Use the **Sales** tab to record a completed sale:

1. Select the item and enter the quantity sold and the unit price (defaults to the item's listed price).
2. Select **Record Sale**.
3. The system checks that enough stock is available — if you try to sell more than is in stock, the sale is rejected with a clear message.
4. On success, the item's quantity is reduced automatically and the sale appears in the Sales list and in the item's history.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Sales Tab]

10. Viewing Inventory (Search, Filter, Low Stock)

The **Low Stock** tab lists every item at or below its configured reorder threshold, so staff can quickly see what needs reordering without scanning the full inventory list.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Low Stock View]

11. Stock Movement / History

Every Stock-In, Stock-Out, and sale-triggered stock change is recorded as a **StockMovement** and is visible on the relevant item's Detail page, most recent first, each entry showing the type (IN/OUT), quantity, and timestamp.

12. Managing Suppliers

The **Suppliers** tab lists all suppliers with the number of items linked to each. Select **Add Supplier** to create a new one (name is required; contact, phone, email, and address are optional). Existing suppliers can be edited or removed from the same screen.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Suppliers Tab]

13. Reports

The **Reports** tab shows total inventory value, a category-by-category value breakdown, and a list of “dead stock” — items that have not sold recently — to help identify slow-moving inventory.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Reports Tab]

14. Settings

The **Settings** tab lets you update the store name, toggle low-stock email notifications, set the notification email address, and (if using email alerts) enter a Resend API key.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Settings Tab]

Important: the “Passcode” field on this screen does not currently change the login passcode — see the note in Section 4 and `Technical_Debt_Plan.pdf` (TD-01). Do not rely on it until this is fixed.

15. AI Assistant

An AI chat panel is available from the Dashboard, letting you ask natural-language questions such as “What’s low on stock?” or “What was our revenue this week?” If the AI service is temporarily unavailable, StockKeep automatically falls back to a rule-based answer computed from your real data, so the assistant always responds — it may just be less conversational in that case.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - AI Chat Panel]

Item Detail pages may also show an AI-generated stockout forecast (estimated days until the item runs out, and a suggested reorder quantity), again with an automatic fallback calculation if the AI call fails.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - AI Forecast Panel]

16. Validation / Error Messages

StockKeep validates your input before saving. Common messages you may see:

Message (example)	Meaning	What to do
“Name is required”	The item/supplier name field was left blank	Enter a name
“Cannot remove N units. Current stock is M. Stock cannot drop below 0.”	A Stock-Out or sale would take quantity negative	Reduce the quantity, or restock first
“Insufficient stock! Requested N units, but current stock is M.”	A sale exceeds available stock	Reduce the sale quantity
“Incorrect passcode, try again”	The wrong passcode was entered at login	Re-enter the correct passcode

17. Logout

Select **Logout** from the navigation menu at any time to end your session. You will be returned to the Login screen, and will need to re-enter the passcode to access the system again.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Logout Confirmation]

18. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely Cause	Suggested Fix
Can't log in with a passcode that used to work	The passcode is controlled by the <code>APP_PASSCODE</code> environment variable / hardcoded default, not the Settings screen (see TD-01)	Confirm the passcode with whoever deployed the system
Page redirects back to Login unexpectedly	Session cookie expired (7-day limit) or was cleared by the browser	Log in again
AI chat gives a short, generic answer instead of a detailed one	The AI (Gemini) service call failed and the rule-based fallback answered instead — this is expected, safe behaviour, not a crash	Try again later, or check the Gemini API key/model configuration with your developer
Adding an item with a negative or zero quantity/threshold returns an unexpected error	Known issue DEF-01 (see <code>Testing_Report.pdf</code>) — validation correctly blocks the bad data, but the error response is not currently clean	Re-enter the value as zero or positive as appropriate; report to your developer if this persists in the live deployment

19. Frequently Encountered Problems

1. **“I changed the passcode in Settings but the old one still works.”** This is expected in the current build — see Section 15 and `Technical_Debt_Plan.pdf` TD-01.
2. **“The AI answers feel repetitive.”** The fallback answers are template-based by design, to guarantee the assistant never fails outright; this indicates the live AI call is not succeeding (see `Testing_Report.pdf`, DEF-04).
3. **“I can’t find a way to view more than the most recent 100 sales.”** This is a known limitation (`Technical_Debt_Plan.pdf`, TD-10) — pagination is not yet implemented.

20. Contact / Support

For issues with this system, contact: **[SUPPORT CONTACT — TO BE PROVIDED BY STUDENT]**